

QUT Student Teams/Clubs Activity Funding Application Form

This form must be used for all requests for Electrical Engineering and Robotics (EER) School funding for club activities. For example, funding for competitions, club travel, conferences, and other speciality activities. This form runs continuously and is separate from the "Project Funding Rounds". Applications will be reviewed by the EER engagement committee.

Purpose

This program supports QUT student clubs in undertaking valuable initiatives aligned with university values and long-term development goals. It aims to promote high-impact student engagement, co-funding responsibility, and broader visibility of QUT student team and club achievements.

Funding Overview

- Funding Amount: Up to 50% of total eligible activity cost (maximum amount determined by available budget)
- Co-funding Requirement: Clubs must secure external co-funding for at least 50% of total costs

Conditions

1. External Co-Funding: Proof of 50% or more co-funding must be submitted with this application. Income from future fundraising activities may be considered, subject to the return clause.
2. Return Clause: If 50% co-funding is not secured within 4 weeks of the event, the school's money will be returned.
3. Funded participants must engage with the QUT/faculty marketing team to showcase their achievements.
4. A short 1-page reporting is due to the EER engagement committee and must include a short outcomes summary and photos.
5. Marketing and reporting must be completed by the end of the next semester's O-week.

Assessment Criteria

Applications will be assessed on:

- Benefit to QUT, particularly benefit to EER's national and international profile, engagement, and diversity and inclusion goals
- Direct benefit to the core students who will be involved in conducting the activity. This benefit must be specific to each student's career goals.
- Benefit to the club/team's long-term goals
- Budget reasonableness and justification

Please submit applications via email to andrew.f.stephens@qut.edu.au

Eligible Spending

Funding can be spent on equipment, transit costs (travel), accommodation, consumables, education and training, conference registration, room hire, and food. For all other spending, please get written approval from your academic champion.

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Application Form

1. Club Name: QUT Aerospace Society

2. Main Contact (Name & Email): Charlotte Kelly, qutaerospacesociety@qut.edu.au / c43.kelly@connect.qut.edu.au

3. Title of Activity/Initiative: Fixed Wing Drone Project

4. Description of Activity (max 150 words):

This project aims to develop a fixed-wing drone for beyond visual line of sight (BVLOS) observation missions. This project will have a sophisticated long-range system capable of advanced onboard decision making, including object detection for a diverse range of applications with a particular interest in shark spotting, monitoring of threatened ecosystems, and in agricultural applications.

5. Activity Date(s): Semester 1-2, 2026

6. # members who will directly benefit: 6

7. Location (if applicable): Gardens Point S920, flight location TBC (relevant risk assessment to be made once a suitable location is determined, will not be on a QUT campus)

Criteria Responses (Max 100 words per section)

A. Benefit to EER/QUT:

The Believer BVLOS platform directly strengthens QUT's national identity as a leader in robotics and autonomous systems by providing a tangible, student-operated research asset. The platform's intended applications — shark spotting, environmental monitoring, and agricultural observation — generate compelling, real-world impact stories that elevate QUT's public profile and attract industry engagement. Prospective students and industry partners, particularly in aerospace, robotics, and remote sensing, will see QUT students operating a sophisticated long-range UAS, reinforcing the university's applied learning reputation. The project aligns with QUT's 2023–2027 strategy through its focus on innovation, industry engagement, and practical research outcomes, while its platform-agnostic avionics architecture ensures long-term value across multiple future club and university projects.

B. Direct Benefit to Students (1-2 lines per student):

This project immerses students in the full UAS engineering lifecycle — systems integration, flight testing, regulatory compliance, and industry liaison — unavailable in a classroom setting.

- Julian Williams (Program Manager): End-to-end systems engineering across avionics integration, ArduPlane tuning, RF communications, and CASA regulatory navigation.
- Avionics & Navigation members: Hands-on configuration and validation of real GNSS hardware and Kalman filter tuning, directly reinforcing embedded systems and RF coursework.
- Software & Autonomy members: Practical onboard decision-making, computer vision, and machine learning integration on a live aerial platform.
- All members: Professional UAS operational practices, CASA compliance, and industry engagement with CSIRO and BNEMAC, building networks and regulatory literacy relevant to aerospace and robotics careers.

C. Benefit to Club's Long-Term Goals:

The Believer project advances QUTAS's goal of maintaining a suite of active, iterative engineering platforms that grow in capability year-on-year. Building on an existing airframe and prior financial investment, this phase focuses on avionics upgrades that unlock BVLOS operations, onboard autonomy, and sensing — forming the foundation for future research-grade capability. Standardising on ExpressLRS across fixed-wing and multirotor platforms reduces fragmentation and simplifies onboarding for new members. Long-term, the platform is intended to support university teaching and research activities, positioning QUTAS as a club that contributes meaningfully beyond competition, and making it attractive to students across aerospace, electrical, robotics, software, and mechanical disciplines from their first semester.

Budget Summary

Item	Amount (AUD)	Justification	Link

RadioMaster GX12 Dual-Band Gemini-X Radio Controller Transmitter	\$350	ELRS Compatible transmitter, compatible with other common radio protocols	Controller Link
RadioMaster XR4 Gemini Xrossband Dual Band ExpressLRS ELRS Receiver	\$50	ELRS Compatible, dual band receiver, along with transmitter can be used on any future drone projects	Receiver Link
ZED-F9P Positioning Module	\$220	Highly Accurate GPS Module, compatible with all drone projects, multi-band GNSS reception	GPS Link
IMX335 5MP USB Camera	\$64	Camera module for local decision making	Camer Link
2200mAh 6S 60C LiPo	\$46	High load and high discharge rate battery	Battery Link
Miscellaneous and Sundries	\$300	Allocated to unforeseen costs such as fasteners, cabling, adhesives, paint, minor hardware, 3D printing avionics integration	-
MatekSys Power Distribution Board	\$45	Power distribution solution between battery and all modules	PDB Link
Battery Velcro Straps	\$4	High-strength battery straps	Velcro Link

Total Cost: \$1,379

External Co-Funding Secured: \$689.50 (Source: QUTAS Account, money from guild and various sponsorships from previous years)

EER Funding Requested: \$689.50 (Must be $\leq$ 50% of total cost)

Attach quotes or documents to support the budget where applicable.

Confirmation

- ☒ We confirm we have secured 50% or more external co-funding
- ☒ We agree to the conditions laid out about marketing and reporting requirements, and can meet the timelines
- ☒ We understand that funds must be returned if co-funding is not secured

Signed (President):  (Charlotte Kelly) Date: 20/05/2026

Signed (Treasurer): Joade Lennox Date: 21/5/26

Signed (Academic Champion):  Date: 25/05/2026